



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Tree, three, torn, thorn!



Learning Outcome

Describe environmental change in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about global warming?
- Has the weather in your country changed? How?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe environmental problems.
- I can say and use the sounds *tree* and *three*.
- I can use proper intonation in finished and unfinished ideas.

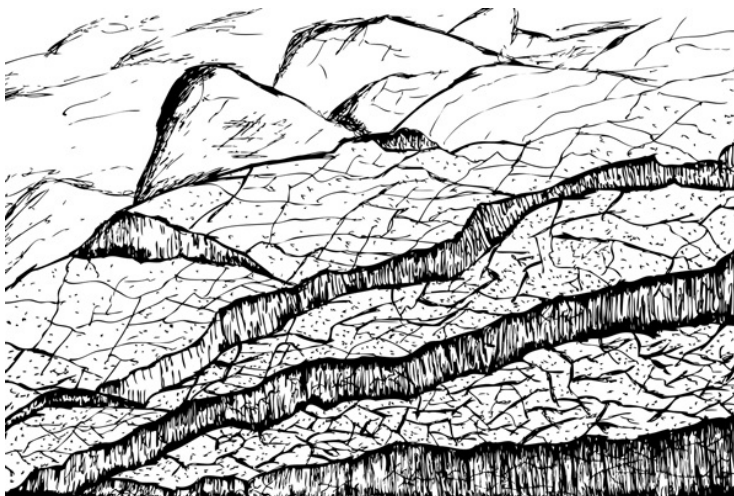




Let's Explore!

Sally interviews a global warming **expert***.

* An "expert" is a person who knows a lot about a particular subject.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: Thank you for joining me today, Ms. Goodman ...

Ms. Goodman: You're welcome.

Sally: My readers are very concerned with global warming. What knowledge can you add to the discussion?

Ms. Goodman: One effect of global warming could be drought. In some arid places, it does not rain much and the trees depend on water from lakes and rivers. When the temperature rises, water evaporates faster. If the temperature were to rise, even by three degrees, the water in these areas would evaporate and cause a water shortage. The soil would be torn up by dryness and all that would remain on the plants would be the thorns.

Sally: That's terrible, but ...

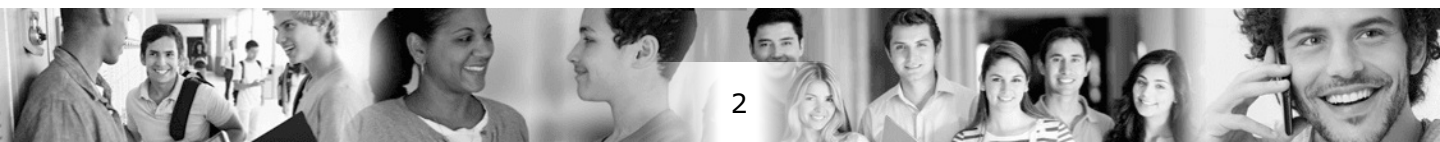
Ms. Goodman: Yes, it is. A drought could also increase the rate of global warming. With fewer plants to take carbon dioxide out of the air, the atmosphere would continue to heat up and cause other drastic changes throughout the world.

Sally: My readers would like to know ...

Ms. Goodman: Thanks to projects that install rain collection tanks in arid countries, only a tenth of the world's population remains thirsty and living in make-shift tents for shelter from the sun.

Sally: Unfortunately that's all the time we have today ...

Ms. Goodman: Thank you for having me.





Let's Practice!

Three thorns on the three trees.

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the options you are given. Use the sentences to model a conversation with a partner. Switch roles.

1. The _____ depend on ...
a. trees
b. threes
2. The soil has been _____ by the hot sun.
a. thorn
b. torn up
3. We need to give _____ ...
a. thanks
b. tanks
4. One _____ has been ...
a. tenth
b. tent
5. Families have been grouped in _____ ...
a. threes
b. trees
6. There's a _____ in that branch ...
a. thorn
b. torn



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about global warming!

Instructions: Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check the pronunciation with your instructor.

1. One effect of global warming could be drought.
2. In some arid places, it does not rain much and the trees depend on water from lakes and rivers.
3. The water in these areas would evaporate and cause a water shortage.
4. With fewer plants to take carbon dioxide out of the air, the atmosphere would continue to heat up and cause other drastic changes throughout the world.
5. Only a tenth of the world's population remains thirsty and living in make-shift tents for shelter from the sun.





Extension Activity

Watch *An Inconvenient Truth*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Watch the movie *An Inconvenient Truth*.
- Write down any familiar words or phrases that you hear related to the environment.
- Summarize the movie in a paragraph and share your summary with a partner.
- Discuss the ideas presented in the movie and your opinion on global warming.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I describe and discuss environmental problems.

☐ ☐

I watch the movie *An Inconvenient Truth* and write a summary of it.

☐ ☐

I listen for familiar words and phrases.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **drought** (noun): a long period of dry weather and no rain
e.g. One effect of global warming could be drought.
- **arid** (adjective): very dry because of a lack of rain
e.g. In some arid places, it does not rain.
- **thorn** (noun): a sharp point that grows on the stem of a plant such as a rose or a cactus
e.g. All that would remain on the plants would be the thorns.
- **to evaporate** (verb): to change from a liquid to a gas
e.g. The water in these areas would evaporate and cause a water shortage.
- **make-shift** (adjective): temporary and low quality, but used because of a sudden need
e.g. A tenth of the world's population remains thirsty and living in make-shift tents for shelter from the sun.
- **to install** (verb): to put equipment somewhere and connect it so that it is ready to be used
e.g. There are projects that install rain collection tanks in arid countries.





Learning Points

Minimal Pairs - *t* and *th*

Minimal Pairs are two words that sound similar, except for one sound.

The sounds *t* and *th* are quite different.

To make the sound *t*, your tongue touches the area behind your top front teeth (alveolar ridge). The sound *t* is unvoiced.

To make the sound *th*, your tongue sits between your teeth and the air passes around the tongue. The sound is unvoiced.

Here are a list of minimal pairs with the *t* and *th* sounds. As you read them, focus on the difference between the two sounds.

<i>t</i> sound	<i>th</i> sound
tree	three
torn	thorn
tanks	thanks
tent	tenth

Examples:

- *In some arid places, it does not rain much and the trees depend on water from lakes and rivers.*
- *If the temperature were to rise, even by three degrees, the water in these areas would evaporate and cause a water shortage.*
- *The soil would be torn up by dryness and all that would remain on the plants would be the thorns.*
- *Thanks to projects that install rain collection tanks in arid countries, only a tenth of the world's population remains thirsty and living in make-shift tents for shelter from the sun.*





Learning Points

Intonation of Finished and Unfinished Ideas

Intonation tells us a lot about how someone feels and whether they have completed their thoughts or not. It is important to listen carefully to the rise and fall of people's voices.

In English, there are three intonation patterns:

1. Falling
2. Rising
3. Partial Falling

You should use **falling** intonation at the end of a thought group, sentence or an information question to tell the listener that you are finished with that statement.

For example:

*My readers are very concerned with global **warming**.* ↘

Likewise, your pitch will only **partially fall** at the end of a thought group to:

- give the listener's brain time to "digest" the speech; and
- tell the listener that you are not finished speaking.

For example:

*That's terrible, **but** ...*

You should use **rising** intonation at the end of a yes/no question. The rising pitch indicates to the listener that you would like an answer.

For example:

*Are you concerned about global **warming**?* ↗

Examples:

- *Thank you for joining me today, Ms. Goodman ... (PARTIALLY DOWN)*
- *You're welcome. (DOWN)*
- *What knowledge can you add to the discussion? (DOWN)*
- *That's terrible, but ... (PARTIALLY DOWN)*
- *My readers would like to know ... (PARTIALLY DOWN)*

